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# 'Took 30 Years to Get Back in Majors,' Says Happy Cohen

By BOB BEEBE
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

The Andy Cohen-Charlie Wagner mutual admiration society was in session over the week-end as things warmed up for the 13th annual Baseball Boosters' dinner at the Pick-Nicollet hotel tonight.

The two old teammates from the 1937 Millers went out to dinner together Saturday night and rallied again last night to listen to Jack Onslow's Fund of stories.

"Did you know," said Wagner, "that Andy gave me my first chance with Minneapolis? Well he did. On the first trip of the season, Donie Bush was sick and Andy was handling the club. He sent me in to relieve one day, then he gave me a start. I was just a kid and Andy really looked after me."

"That's right," Andy grinned. "I guess I was your keeper. And you did all right, you just won 20 ball games."

Cohen, who will be tonight's guest of honor, is as happy as a rookie about his new job as coach of the Philadelphia Phillies after being out of baseball a year.

"It's great to be back in the big league," he said. "And it took me quite a while to get back, too. Just a matter of 30 years. The Giants sent me down to Newark in 1930 and I've been in the minors ever since."

Meanwhile, the program was shorn of one of its luminaries when word came from Los Angeles that manager Gene Mauch would be unable to attend and receive his American Association manager of the year award from league president Ed Doherty.

Mrs. Mauch phoned that he was down in bed with the flu. Gene however, sent this message: "Tell the fans the Millers will be shooting for first place. We'll have a younger, faster club."

Onslow figures that Miller graduate Eddie Sadowski can help the Red Sox.

"He's a great receiver—there aren't enough of his type around today—and he's got a top arm, Jack pointed out. "He might do a little damage to that left field fence in Fenway park, too."

The veteran scout will be making his third straight appearance at the dinner which will be emceed for the 13th straight year by Halsey Hall. General manager George Brophy will accept Mauch's award from Doherty who has been in the Twin Cities for nearly a week while the balance of the cast was due in today.

White Sox pitcher Bob Shaw and Rip Collins are coming from Chicago where they appeared last night. Bill Skowron, the Yankee slugger, also will be at the head table along with Houston manager Enos Slaughter who is coming from his home in North Carolina. Gov. Orville Freeman also will speak.

The affair has been a sellout of more than 800 since Saturday. Doors will be open at 6:15 p.m. and dinner will be served at 6:30.

HEAD TABLE figures of tonight's Baseball Boosters dinner at the Pick-Nicollet warmed up Sunday night with a yarn-spinning session. Here Boston Red Sox scout Jack Onslow (left) relates one of his countless baseball anecdoes to Halsey Hall who will be toastmaster at the gathering, guest of honor Andy Cohen and Charlie Wagner, assistant farm director of the Red Sox.—Star photo by Paul Siegel.

# NFL Stalemated But Owners Are Avoiding Feuds

★MIAMI BEACH, Fla.—As the National Football league's deadlock over a new commissioner makes history, the one significant feature is that no bitterness has developed among the opposing groups.

This stalemate was adjourned at 12:07 a.m. today on the 21st ballot with both sides standing pat.

The voting changed only with the minority of four—George Marshall, Washington; Carroll Rosenbloom, Baltimore; Art Rooney, Pittsburgh, and Frank McNamee, Philadelphia, switching from Art Kellett of Baltimore to Austin Gunsel, acting commissioner.

LOWDOWN ON SPORTS

By Charles Johnson

Here are two groups that refuse to budge. The strange thing is that the seven behind Marshall Leahy haven't as much as suggested a compromise candidate. The four in the minority at least have voted for as many as four different men. Since the first ballot George Halas has passed, waiting for a break.

All of a sudden this prolonged deadlock has become important news around Miami Beach with curious tourists joining the newspaper gang that has been carrying on the "death watch" since last Wednesday to find out if any progress has been made.

As Florida's cold wave continues, visitors won't brave the elements any more so they move in on the National league sessions.

Strange as it may seem, there has been no name-calling and no involvement of personalities in the tedious sessions. The voters come out of each session without malice toward each other and apparently no worry that they may have to fight it out for the rest of the winter.

In the meantime, the man the seven owners are backing—Leahy—checked out of his hotel and left his forwarding address as San Francisco. That left only Gunsel on the scene. He can't leave because he's still on the league's payroll.

* * *

### To Bitter End

★BECAUSE EXPANSION can't come before this meeting until a commissioner of some sort is elected, the Minnesota delegation is stuck here.

"I'll stay until the bitter end," said Max Winter of Minneapolis early today when the gathering adjourned until this afternoon.

Max already has cancelled a meeting in Philadelphia that had to do with basketball and he is scheduled to be in New York Tuesday afternoon.

Ole Haugsrud of Duluth was due in San Francisco for a meeting of his industry. He may be forced to take off today, but he isn't sure.

What the Minnesotans are afraid of is that if they leave here, the league may take it to mean they have lost interest in getting a franchise. The Dallas delegation is standing by as hotel bills of $25 to $35 a day keep running up with each adjourned session.

* * *

### Minutes Recovered

★ABOUT THE ONLY bit of news, if it could be called that, to break Sunday was that the minutes of one of the early meetings—last Wednesday—had been found.

They belonged to Joe Lebrun, publicity director. The culprit slipped the scribbled notes under the door of Joe's hotel room last night and now he's happy.

But some 40 newspapermen who have held the death watch for a week are becoming furious.

* * *

### Costly White Elephant

★AS THE FRUSTRATED newspapermen sit around the press room during these boring delays and lack of action, they talk about the sport problems in their own areas.

The Los Angeles crowd got on the subject of the Olympic Winter games which may get started before the National league owners finish their annual meeting.

The state of California already has eight million dollars of the taxpayers' money invested in the Squaw Valley venture. There also is two million dollars of Uncle Sam's cash. The committee has asked the state to toss in another million just in case they can't pay off at the finish.

Once the games are over, this could be the worst white elephant sports has known in years.

There can be very little salvaged out of the millions invested. About all that can be put to use for income will be the skiing facilities. The ice rink will be almost a total loss. The artificial ice maker could be sold, but its value will be nothing compared to the original costs because any buyer will have a terrific overhead dismantling and moving it.

It will be many years before the criticism of this outlay of tax money will die down once the complete story is told.

* * *

### Had It Coming

★NO TEARS WERE SHED among the sport enthusiasts around Miami Beach when they saw Sugar Ray Robinson shorn of the small share of the middleweight boxing championship he once held.

His defeat at the hands of Paul Pender serves him right. He became so arrogant and impossible once he was recognized as the world's king of the 160-pounders that a majority were pulling against him when he finally returned to action.

Sugar Ray was recognized as tops only in New York and Massachusetts when licked last Friday. Of course, he will get a return match in 90 days for another payoff. But no one is worried about that. He looked so bad against Pender that even this ordinary fighter figures to do it again in the second try.

When in his prime, Robinson was one of the great fistic machines of all times. However, his conduct since his successful comeback has soured the American sports public so much they'll quickly forget his tremendous ability of other days.

# Felix's Coming Unites Old Foes

"That Ray Felix is pretty cute," Larry Foust was saying one day.

"He claims you're doing things to him and wants fouls called. But he's one of the slickest in the business, knows all the tricks himself."

RAY FELIX
*Comes to Lakers*

So now Larry and Ray are teammates, along with Jim Krebs, another Laker center, who has had his jousts with Felix in bygone days when the 6-11 Negro star of Long Island U was one of the more feared players in the NBA. A couple of times the boys were ready to square off.

**The Lakers acquired him Sunday in exchange for Dick Garmaker and a sum believed to be $25,000. The Lakers gave up their No. 2 draft choice but also obtained a lower ranking draft choice from the Knicks.**

The deal is two-pronged. It was a financial necessity and it may carry benefit. Felix and Fuzzy Levane, who started the season as Knick coach before being succeeded by Carl Braun, did not see eye to eye and long Ray was shipped to Allentown, Pa., of the secondary Eastern league where he has been playing well.

It was Gar's skill as an opportunist that really swung the deal.

In a league where a guy 6-6 qualifies for Singer's Midgets, the 6-11 Felix will add rebound power under the hoop and he'll make his debut when the Lakers play Cincinnati at Detroit Sunday. They also hope Elgin Baylor's jammed middle finger on the right hand won't handicap him too much.

Meanwhile, St. Louis set a season's record last night with 155 points in downing New York, which scored 129. Right after, Braun announced he was retiring as a player to make room for Garmaker.

Wilt Chamberlain led Philadlephia over Cincinnati 104-95 and Boston took Syracuse 131-110.

**NBA STANDINGS**

EASTERN DIVISION

| | W. | L. | Pct. | G.B. |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boston | 38 | 10 | .792 | ... |
| Philadelphia | 32 | 14 | .696 | 5 |
| Syracuse | 27 | 21 | .563 | 11 |
| New York | 19 | 29 | .396 | 19 |

WESTERN DIVISION

| | W. | L. | Pct. | G.B. |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| St. Louis | 27 | 18 | .600 | ... |
| Detroit | 19 | 28 | .404 | 9 |
| Minneapolis | 13 | 31 | .295 | 13½ |
| Cincinnati | 14 | 38 | .269 | 16½ |

# Ted Signs-- in Private

BOSTON, Mass.—(UPI)—Ted Williams slipped into the Red Sox front office unnoticed today and signed his 1960 contract with general manager Bucky Harris. He then slipped away before newsmen could interview him.

Williams

"He came in a side door," said Red Sox publicist Jack Malaney. "He sat down with Bucky, had a short talk, signed and said he had to go. I didn't even see him."

"Bucky was smiling," Malaney said.

Asked about a quoted statement that he (Harris) believed the team might be better off without the 41-year-old outfielder, Harris said he was "horribly misquoted."

The salary was believed to be the same $60,000 figure that Williams revealed recently he had been paid last year.



# Iowa Proves If We're Men--Kundla

By DICK GORDON
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

"This game will show whether we're men or not."

It was John Kundla, Minnesota basketball coach, talking by long distance phone from Iowa City and he was referring to tonight's 7:30 battle with Iowa in the Hawkeyes' own back yard.

"This one is the real test," said Kundla, obviously disappointed by the 62-61 defeat at Northwestern which removed the Gophers from a contending spot in the Big Ten race.

"We got tense and made too many mistakes against Northwestern. But maybe it wasn't in the cards for us to win the way Ron Johnson's last shot rolled off the rim. That's over, though, the boys have got to forget all about that now."

**Kundla hopes his players can get over their tenseness and still be up tonight.**

"We've got to be up," he said, "because Iowa will be mad after that loss at Michigan State and they will get plenty of help from the home crowd. But if the boys play their game, we can win."

With Ohio States (4-0) currently spread-eagling the Big Ten field after Saturday's triumph at Purdue, Iowa and Minnesota are battling for second place.

The Hawkeyes are 4-2 and Minnesota 3-2, with the Gophers holding an earlier 70-61 decision over Iowa in Minneapolis.

**However, for the record, Minnesota has not swept a series with the Hawakeyes since 1949. On the other hand, its last victory at Iowa City ,was in 1955 and followed right after another heartbreaking loss to a rallying Northwestern team.**

So history, in one sense, is on the Gopher side.

Ron Johnson got 22 points for the Gophers against the Cats and Kundla said Marlo Miller played his best all-around game with 12.

Iowa will show a new face. Mike Dull, 6-5 sophomore, didn't play at all against the Gophers here three weeks ago.

It was a lost weekend almost all the way for the Gophers. In addition to the cage defeat at Northwestern, the pucksters tied and lost to the Olympics, the wrestlers, with something of a makeshift lineup, bowed in the last bout to Iowa and both the gymnasts and the swimmers fell before Michigan State squads.

**BIG TEN**

| | Conference W | Conference L | All Games W | All Games L |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ohio State | 4 | 0 | 12 | 2 |
| Iowa | 4 | 2 | 12 | 4 |
| Illinois | 3 | 2 | 10 | 3 |
| Michigan State | 3 | 2 | 8 | 4 |
| Minnesota | 3 | 2 | 7 | 8 |
| Northwestern | 3 | 2 | 6 | 8 |
| Purdue | 2 | 3 | 7 | 7 |
| Indiana | 1 | 3 | 9 | 4 |
| Michigan | 0 | 3 | 2 | 10 |
| Wisconsin | 0 | 4 | 3 | 10 |

MINNEAPOLIS baseball prospects for 1960 were discussed Sunday by Miller general manager George Brophy (left) and two of his aids—trainer Tom McKenna, and Art Ruane, back from Phoenix, Ariz., to be Miller clubhouse man again.—Star photo.

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# Young Millers Praised

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## ONSLOW, COHEN SAY McGRAW TOPS

By HALSEY HALL
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

Charley Wagner, a 20-game winner for Minneapolis 23 years ago and later a Red Sox reliable, likes the pitching prospects of the future Millers. Especially Ben Tench, who pitched for Allentown last year in class A ball.

"Tench can throw as hard as any man," elucidated old "Broadway" of 1937. "He throws as hard as Earl Wilson. He has been wild, which didn't help the batters any but he has improved the past two years. If he can find the strike zone consistently he'll be a real dandy.

**"You know about Tracy Stallard from last year and he'll be better with experience. There's no doubt about the strength of your pitching next season."**

Charley feels Wilson undoubtedly suffered from being called up too early by Boston.

"Here's the thing. We recalled Pumpsie Green, too, but Pumpsie had been at spring training with the Boston club. He had mingled with the fellows, had picked up the 'feel' of the majors. To Wilson it was all new. Sometimes that can be a bit of a shock. Yet he did pitch some good ball for us."

**Wagner got on the subject of relaxation. "That's what makes Al Lopez (White Sox) a great manager. He has the ability to teach his pitchers how to relax. He has patience, tremendous patience."**

While they were speaking of managers, old "Rough and Ready," Jack Onslow, nominated John McGraw as his No. 1 all-time-choice. And Andy Cohen agreed. Both were under the Little Napoleon's standard at the Polo Grounds.

Andrew shook his head. "Mac was a genius. Yes, I had a chance at second base. But then I found myself trying to beat out Frank Frisch and another year I was trying to beat out Rogers Hornsby."

Andrew shook his head again.

*CONTINENTAL HITS HOUSTON SNAG*

# AA Charges Tampering

HOUSTON, Tex.—(AP)—Open warfare over baseball territorial rights rumbled on today as continental league president Branch Rickey sought to iron out franchise troubles.

Pot shots by feuding factions whizzed amdist dealing between local Continental franchise holders and owners of the class AAA American Association Houston Buffs. Rickey hinted his loop might move elsewhere.

Doherty

"I am warning you to stay out of cities in my league or I will demand your expulsion from baseball," American association president Ed Doherty wired Rickey's personal representative Saturday night.

The envoy, owner Allen Russell of the Austin club of the Texas league, replied in effect that Doherty was no one to call the kettle black.

• • •

Buff directors met today in what was believed a session to place a price tag on the triple A club. President Marty Marion earlier claimed the club was worth $492,500 in investments and commitments. Russell said the franchise brought only $100,000 when purchased a year ago.

**Craig Cullinan, Jr., leader of the Houston Sports association, which owns the Continental franchise, dismissed the figure as "utterly ridiculous."**

"I regret terribly the possible loss of Houston," Rickey wired Cullinan. Rickey seeks to gain territorial rights from the Buffs in order that work on a new public stadium may get under way."

"It is now a prospective choice between Houston and Montreal," he added. "I do not believe you should permit anyone to hold you blamable if the vacated franchise is granted elsewhere. I am not going to hold that baby in my lap either."

Russell said Doherty's telegram stated:

"By what right do you label yourself a mediator for Rickey? I am reporting your conduct to (Texas league president) Dick Butler and George Trautman (president of the minor leagues).

In Minneapolis where he will speak at tonight's baseball dinner, Doherty said:

**"Russell's action burned me up. He should stay in his own league. There is nothing one can do about someone outside baseball but Russell is subject to baseball law. I'm charging him with tampering with American Association territory. I've spoken my piece. The matter now is in the hands of Butler and Trautman."**

The Texas league owner said he replied he didn't care "what threats you make. I just wish you had stayed out of the Texas league in 1958 and previous years."

The American Association drafted Houston, Dallas and Fort Worth from the Texas league before the 1959 season, reducing that circuit from an eight to a six-team league.

Trautman, reached by telephone, said the only way any group could acquire territorial rights would be to deal with both the Buffs and the American Association.

BULLETIN BOARD

# Big Ten to Vote Again on Rose Bowl

CHICAGO—(AP)—The Big Ten has indicated a desire to continue participation in the Rose Bowl football classic by deciding to take another vote on the matter at the spring meetings in Columbus, March 3-5. The fact the post-season game question was revived indicated the Big Ten is not ready to bow out of the Rose Bowl picture.

**FORT LAUDERDALE, Fla.—(AP)—Marlene Stewart Streit still is Doherty golf champion, the first since 1953 to win the women's amateur event twice in succession, after defeating Jean Cici of Long Beach, N. Y. 6 and 5 in the 36-hole finals.**

### Venturi $5,350 Richer Today

PEBBLE BEACH, Calif.—(AP)—After slogging through a wet but profitable victory in Bing Crosby's golfing show, Ken Venturi set his sights today on even higher stakes. Now the 28-year-old Venturi aims for the $100,000 Desert Classic at Palm Springs with its $12,000 top award two weeks hence, after winning $5,350 with a 286 in the worst storm ever to plague the Crosby event Sunday.

**BOSTON, Mass.—(AP)—Paul Pender, fractional world middleweight champion, may bypass a Sugar Ray Robinson rematch for a crack at Gene Fullmer, the key being an unfulfilled contract Fullmer has with Pender.**

### Charge Antitrust Violation

NEW YORK—(AP)—The Associated Press reported today it had learned that affidavits are being filed with the supreme court charging that TelePrompter and Floyd Patterson Enterprises violated the antitrust law by attempting to monopolize promotion of heavyweight boxing fights. The AP said the New York attorney general seeks to dissolve both corporations which had a part in the promotion of the Ingemar Johansson-Floyd Patterson fight last June.

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